

Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός

Heraclides of Pontus on Prosody and Platonic Thought

eul_aid: fdw

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Κοινή](#) [Koine](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία](#) [Philosophy](#)
Format: [Πραγματεία](#) [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Platonist](#)

Heraclides of Pontus was a Greek philosopher and astronomer of the 4th century BCE. Born in Heraclea Pontica on the coast of the Black Sea, he studied in Athens, first under Plato and later under Aristotle, becoming a member of Plato's Academy. Ancient sources indicate he was considered for leadership of the Academy but did not receive the position, eventually returning to his hometown.

Heraclides wrote extensively on a wide range of subjects, including ethics, astronomy, theology, and literature. None of his works survive complete; they are known only through fragments and reports by later authors. Titles attributed to him include **On the Soul**, **On Justice**, and **On the Heavens**. His historical importance lies in his innovative ideas, which blended Platonic, Pythagorean, and early Aristotelian thought.

In astronomy, he is particularly noted for proposing that the Earth rotates on its axis to explain the daily movement of the stars. Some scholars also report that he suggested Venus and Mercury orbit the Sun. In philosophy, his dialogues explored themes like the soul's immortality and the nature of virtue. Modern scholars view him as a significant transitional figure between the philosophy of Plato and the developments of the Hellenistic period.

Works (2)

- [Περὶ δυσκλίων ῥημάτων](#) · [On Difficult Words](#) · 6 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [On Prosody and Accent](#) · 65 passages

Other Platonist Authors

- [Ἀλβῖνος ὁ Πλατωνικός](#) · [Albinus the Platonist](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀλέξανδρος Λυκοπολίτης](#) · [Alexander of Lycopolis](#) · 1 work
- [Ἄνωνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Πλάτωνος Θεαίτητον](#) · [Anonymous Commentary on Plato](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρίμνηστος](#) · [Arimnestus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀττικός](#) · [Atticus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Κάσσιος Λογγῖνος](#) · [Cassius Longinus the Philosopher](#) · 3 works
- [Κέλσος ὁ Πλατωνικός](#) · [Celsus the Platonist](#) · 1 work
- [Κράντωρ ὁ Σολεύς](#) · [Crantor of Soli](#) · 2 works
- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός](#) · [Heraclides of Pontus II](#) · 1 work

- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus III · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος Προλεγόμενα εἰς τὴν Πλατωνικὴν Φιλοσοφίαν · Introduction Platonism Anonymous · 1 work
- Νουμήνιος ὁ ἐξ Ἀπαμείας · Numenius of Apamea · 1 work